European Commission

SHE FIGURES 2024

The road to gender equality in R&I

France

She Figures Index 2024

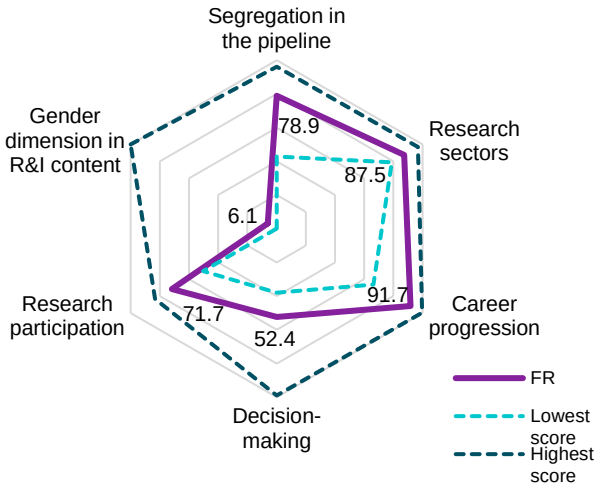
The **She Figures Index** is a tool to measure the extent to which European Union (EU) Member States have achieved gender equality in the European Research Area (ERA). It draws on She Figures indicators across six dimensions: segregation in the pipeline, research sectors, career progression, decision-making, research participation, and incorporating a gender dimension in research and innovation (R&I) content (GDRIC).

A score of between 0 and 100 is assigned to each dimension, as well as an overall score. A score of 100 denotes that gender equality has been fully achieved. Among the Member States, France ranks 23rd overall, with a score of 64.7. The breakdown indicates a relatively high score on the dimension of research participation (7th), moderate scores on segregation in the pipeline (12th) and career progression (13th), and lower scores on research sectors (20th), decision-making (25th) and GDRIC (25th).

France 64.7

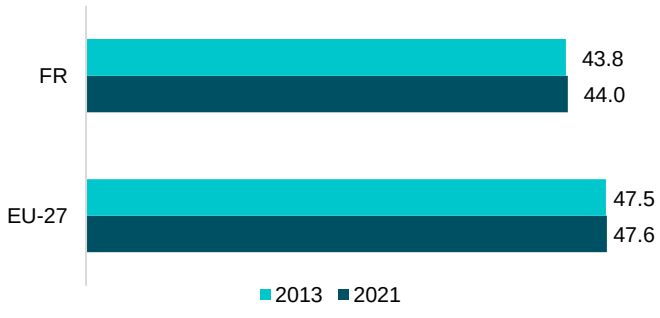
Lowest score 60.1

Highest score 87.6



Pool of graduate talent

Figure 1: Proportion (%) of women among Doctoral graduates (ISCED 8), 2013 and 2021

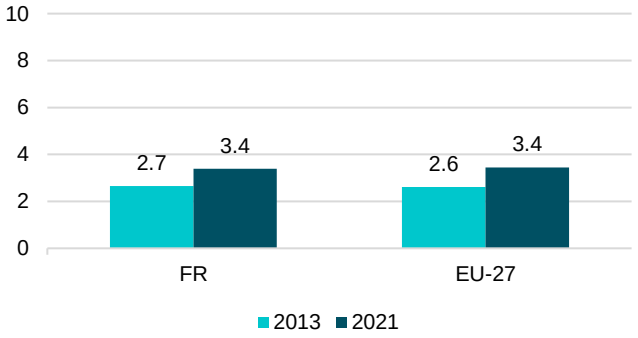


Notes: ISCED 8 = International Standard Classification of Education, Doctoral level or equivalent.
Source: Eurostat – Education Statistics (online data code: educ_uoe_grad02); Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) (Graduates by field).

Findings from She Figures 2024 show that **France has achieved gender balance in the proportion of women among Doctoral graduates**. Women represented 44 % of Doctoral graduates in both 2021 and 2013. Of the 27 European Union Member States (EU-27), France has the 24th highest proportion of women among Doctoral graduates, slightly below the EU-27 average (48 %).

Participation in science and technology occupations

Figure 2: Proportion (%) of women scientists and engineers among total labour force, 2013 and 2021



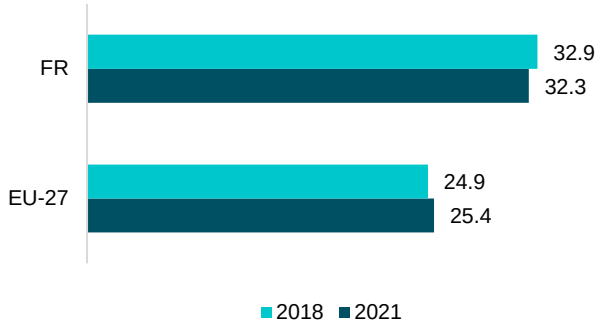
Notes: Break in time series for 2021 FR and EU-27 data. The definition differs for 2021 FR data, see metadata. S&Es = scientists and engineers.
Source: Eurostat – Human resources in science and technology (online data code: hrst_st_ncat) and Eurostat – Labour Force Survey (EU-LFS) – Active population by sex, age and citizenship (online data code: lfsa_agan).

In France, **women scientists and engineers (S&Es) comprise 3.4 % of the labour force,** based on 2021 data, compared to 2.7 % in 2013. The latest data show that France performs similarly to the EU-27 average (3.4 % in 2021).

Research and Innovation

In 2020, the Ministry of Higher Education, Research, and Innovation funded 24 projects in universities and other institutions to combat gender-based violence in higher education and research ([i]). Funded projects included a national programme to encourage girls (under 18 years old) to pursue careers in tech and information technology (IT), and a programme to raise girls' awareness of careers in engineering.

Figure 3: Proportion (%) of women among self-employed S&Es and ICT professionals, 2018 and 2021

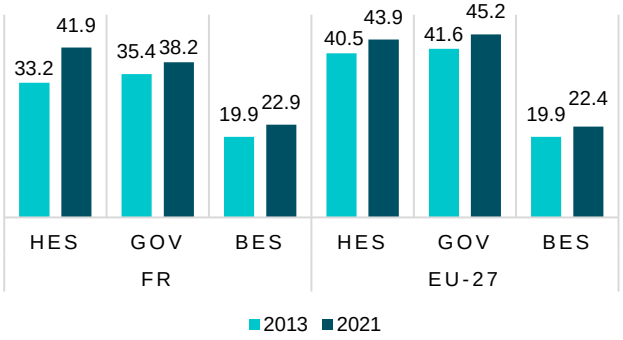


Notes: The definition differs for 2021 FR data, see metadata; Break in time series for 2021 EU-27 and FR data. ICT = information and communications technology.
Source: EE-LFS Annual Average Quarterly data.

Between 2018 and 2021, the proportion of self-employed women among S&Es and information and communications technology (ICT) professionals remained relatively stable, decreasing only slightly, from 33 % to 32 %. Nevertheless, France performs above the EU-27 average and ranks fifth among the EU-27 countries for proportion of self-employed women S&E and ICT professionals (out of 22 Member States).

Labour market participation as researchers

Figure 4: Proportion (%) of women among researchers, by sector of the economy, 2013 and 2021

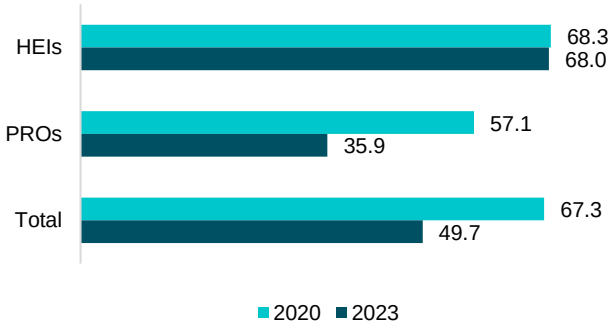


Notes: HES = higher education sector; GOV = government sector; BES = business enterprise sector. EU-27 data for 2021 are estimated.
Source: Eurostat – Research and development statistics (online data code: rd_p_persocc) and OECD-R&D personnel by sector and function.

She Figures 2024 shows that **women represent 30 % of researchers in France**. Gender balance has been achieved in the higher education sector (HES), where women represent over 42 % of researchers. Similarly, women represent 38 % of researchers in the government sector (GOV). Women remain underrepresented in the business enterprise sector (BES), however, accounting for just 23 % of researchers.

Working conditions of researchers

Figure 5: Proportion (%) of research organisations taking actions or measures towards gender equality, by type of organisation, 2020 and 2023



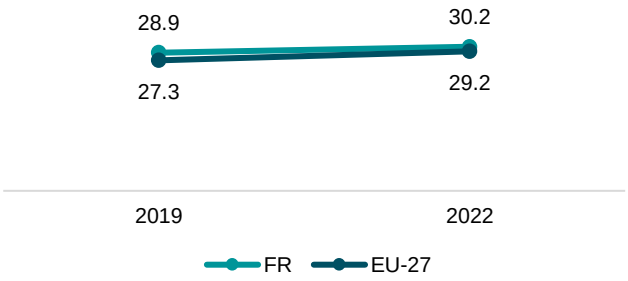
Notes: HEI = higher education institutions; PRO = public research organisations.
Source: Web-scraping of HEI and PRO websites using SerpAPI, informed by ETER, Cordis and input from the national Statistical Correspondents of EU Member States and countries associated with Horizon Europe.

Approximately half of research organisations show information about their actions towards gender equality on their websites. Between 2020 and 2023, the proportion of research organisations displaying these measures on their websites decreased from 67 % to 50 %. This information is more commonly showcased on the websites of HEIs (68 %) than PROs (36 %).

In 2020, the Ministry of Higher Education, Research, and Innovation published a repository for HEIs and research institutions ([ii]). It guides them to develop and implement gender equality plans (GEPs) by providing tools and good practice examples from other institutions.

Career advancement and participation in decision-making

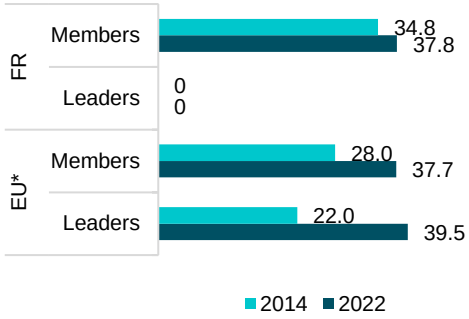
Figure 6: Proportion (%) of women among Grade A positions, 2019 and 2022



Notes: FR data for 2022 refer to reference year 2021. The data for FR refer to Grade A researchers, while the data for the EU refer to Grade A researchers and academic staff. Grade A positions are the single highest grade/post at which research is normally conducted within the institutional or corporate system.
Source: Women in Science (WiS) database, Directorate-General (DG) Research and Innovation - T1_questionnaires.

Between 2019 and 2022, **the proportion of Grade A positions held by women researchers increased from 29 % to 30 %.** However, France continues to perform below the EU-27 average for share of women in these positions.

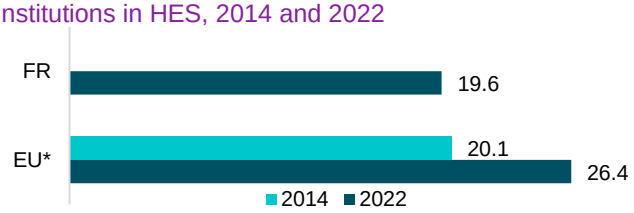
Figure 7: Proportion (%) of women on boards of research organisations (members and leaders), 2014 and 2022



*Notes: *EU-level data for 2014 refer to the EU-28, while EU-level data for 2022 refer to the EU-27. 2017 data for FR refers the year 2017.*
Source: WiS database, DG Research and Innovation - T5 & T6_questionnaires.

She Figures 2024 shows that **women comprise 38 % of members on boards** of research institutions, based on 2022 data**.** Data from 2014 and 2022 show that **women are not represented at all as leaders on boards** of research institutions in either year**.**

Figure 8: Proportion (%) of women among heads of institutions in HES, 2014 and 2022

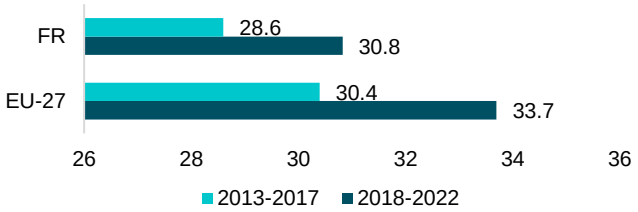


*Notes: FR data for 2014 are not available; *EU-level data for 2014 refer to the EU-28, while EU-level data for 2022 refer to the EU-27.*
Source: WiS database, DG Research and Innovation – T7_questionnaires.

She Figures 2024 shows that **women comprise one-fifth (20 %) of heads of institutions in HES,** based on 2022 data**.** France performs below the EU-27 average for this indicator.

R&I output

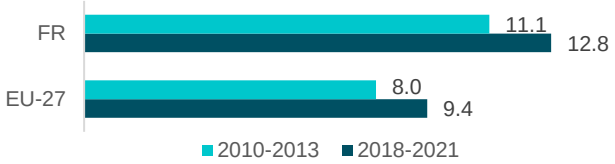
Figure 9: Average proportion (%) of women among authors on publications in all fields of R&D, 2013-2017 and 2018-2022



Notes: R&D = research and development.
Source: Scopus.

Between 2018 and 2022, the average proportion of women among authors of publications in France in all research and development (R&D) fields was 31 %. This figure is slightly lower than the EU-27 average of 34 %. France ranks 20th among the Member States for proportion of women among authors of publications.

Figure 10: Proportion (%) of women among inventors, 2010-2013 and 2018-2021



Source: Computed using European patent applications (kind codes A1 and A2) in PATSTAT.

Women are significantly underrepresented among inventors on patent applications in France and in the EU more broadly. Data from 2018 to 2021 show that women only submit 13 % of patent applications, compared to 9.4 % in the EU-27. France has the seventh highest proportion of women inventors among the EU-27.

Overall, She Figures 2024 finds that France has not followed a consistent trend of improvement in terms of advancing gender equality in R&I. There has been improvement in some areas, such as the proportion of women among Doctoral graduates (Figure 1), the proportion of women scientists and engineers among the total labour force (Figure 2), and the proportion of women among researchers in the HES (Figure 4). Nonetheless, further efforts are needed in the country to increase the proportion of women among self-employed S&E and ICT professionals (Figure 3), to increase the share of women holding Grade A positions (Figure 6), women among heads of higher education institutions (Figure 8), as well as to increase women's research and innovation outputs (Figures 9 and 10).

About She Figures 2024

Gender equality – in all areas of life, and specifically within R&I – is a priority for the EU. She Figures is one of the flagship publications of DG Research and Innovation. Produced every three years, it presents comparable statistics on the state of gender equality in R&I across Europe. The publication provides data for more than 100 indicators to support the European Commission's policy initiatives promoting gender equality in R&I and the ERA. The chapters follow the 'chronological journey' of women and men, from graduating from Doctoral education to participation in the labour market and in decision-making roles. The publication also considers women's and men's relative working conditions and R&I outputs.

Gender Equality in Research and Innovation

Explore She Figures 2024 interactive report and **Gender equality in research and innovation**

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(i) Ministry of Higher Education, Research, and Innovation, Funding for projects in favour of gender equality and the fight against sexist and sexual violence within higher education and research, 2020, https://www.enseignementsup-recherche.gouv.fr/fr/financements-de-projets-en-faveur-de-l-egalite-des-sexes-et-de-la-lutte-contre-les-violences-49282
(ii) Ministry of Higher Education, Research, and Innovation, Repository for Higher Education and Research Institutions, 2020, https://www.enseignementsup-recherche.gouv.fr/fr/plans-d-action-sur-l-egalite-professionnelle-le-mesri-publie-un-referentiel-d-accompagnement-des-46286